5. Use regulator to reduce the pressure of the oxygen in the cylinder to a safer level.
6. Measure the flow in litres per minute. Adjust the flow of oxygen 2 to 4 litres per minute for adults when the nasal catheter is used.
7. Use sterile or disposable nasal catheters to avoid infection.
8. The catheter should be changed at least every 8 hourly to avoid blockage of catheter.
9. The catheter may be taped to the forehead for the comfort of the patient and to keep it in place.
10. Patient's nostrils should be lubricated with petroleum jelly, (Vaseline) if there is any sign of irritation.
11. Oxygen administration must never be stopped until the cause of hypoxia is reversed.
12. If the nurse is leaving the patient for a short period, leave a call bell near the patient.
13. The premature babies should be given oxygen inhalation only for a short time and at a very low concentration to avoid retrolental fibroplasia. (an unusual eye disease occurring in premature infants, usually from being given high concentrations of oxygen, which causes abnormal formation of fibrous tissue behind the lens and often results in blindness.)
14. Observe the patient, receiving oxygen inhalation continuously to detect early signs of oxygen toxicity.
15. Since oxygen helps in combustion, fire precautions are to be taken when the oxygen is on flow.

Highlight

Oxygen is a gas that is needed for the cells in your body so that it can work properly. The air we breathe normally contains 21% oxygen. We can receive up to 100% oxygen.

STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

- Demonstration of the various methods of oxygen administration.

- Oxygen is a chemical element with symbol "O" and atomic number 8. By mass, oxygen is the third-most abundant element in the universe, after hydrogen and helium.
- The new born baby can have birth asphyxia,(brain damage) which happens within 3 to 5 minutes without oxygen.

4.13 ELIMINATION NEEDS.

4.13.1 Introduction

Elimination of the body's waste products is essential for life and comfort. The body eliminates wastes in several ways. The lungs eliminate carbon dioxide and water; the skin eliminates water and sodium; the kidneys eliminate fluids and electrolytes; the intestines discharge solid wastes and fluids. If the body should inappropriately allow wastes to accumulate, many serious conditions can result.

4.13.2 Definition:

It is the process by which waste products are removed from the bowel and bladder by means of faeces and urine.

Nursing-voc_Unit 04.indd 123 22-02-2019 4.44.59 PM